



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Agape Montessori Christian Academy
School Website: <https://4godskidz.wixsite.com/mysite-1/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Agape Montessori Christian Academy (AMCA), Vicksburg, MS 39183, presents itself publicly as a Classical Christian institution with Montessori elements and a Christian worldview. Public materials emphasize a Christ-centered, Christian-principles-based education and a classical framing of education, while also foregrounding Montessori practices in early years and a mixed-curriculum approach (A Beka curriculum alongside Montessori methods). This combination yields a mixed classical signal across the six canonical categories.

- Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Core insights:
 - Religious/metaphysical foundations are clearly present (Christ-centered, Biblical/Christian principles, classical framing), aligning Element 1 closely with classical aims (though not always using explicit liturgical language). Evidence includes a stated classical Christian framework and explicit Christ-centered language.
 - Purpose/goal shows a dual emphasis on formation and preparation for ongoing schooling, with explicit aims around virtue formation and religious grounding but with college/school progression language as well. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signal for Element 2.
 - Curriculum signals are mixed: Montessori and A Beka curricula coexist, but explicit Great Books, grammar-logic-rhetoric liberal arts, or "Great Conversation" elements are not evident in the public materials reviewed. Element 3 is NOT CLASSICAL in explicit terms, though the classical branding is present.
 - Pedagogy shows Montessori practices in early years and a mix of traditional and secular instruction in upper grades. Some classical pedagogical elements (Socratic dialogue, scholé, formal rhetoric) are not clearly evidenced; thus Element 4 rates SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - Faculty signals include references to teachers and small-class context, but a clearly articulated "living curriculum" or explicit classical teacher portrait is not overtly described in the public materials. Element 5 is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - Parent and community engagement includes explicit partnership language with families, parent formation, and open-campus expectations; this aligns Element 6 with CLASSICAL signals.
- What would move the needle: To achieve a robust CLASSICAL rating across all categories, AMCA could more explicitly demonstrate:
 - Element 3: Adoption or explicit integration of Great Books and the liberal arts (Trivium/Quadrivium) within a unified curriculum plan, with references to "great books" and "great conversation."
 - Element 4: Greater use of Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy in upper grades, plus explicit scholé/restful learning language in practice.
 - Element 5: A formal "living curriculum" statement and a published teacher-persona/portrait reflecting classical teacher-mentor ideals.

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- Abstract takeaway: AMCA leans toward CLASSICAL in its religious/crystalized identity and community partnerships, but its curriculum and pedagogy signals are not fully classical as defined by the Six Essential Elements. The aggregate tilt is toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Executive summaries for each category follow, with evidence, keyword analyses, and rationale.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - AMCA publicly brands itself as a Classical Christian environment, signaling a religious-metaphysical focus aligned with classical aims. The home page emphasizes a Classical Christian environment and a christ-centered framework. - The site repeatedly frames education within a Christian worldview and biblical principles (A Beka curriculum described as Christian principles and Biblical study). - A Christ-centered environment is explicitly mentioned in the AMCA content. - Additional pages reference Christian character formation and biblical instruction (A Beka curriculum used to “provide a foundation for academic success and Christian character building”).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Christ-centered, Christian Principles, Biblical study, Christian character, theology (implied through Biblical instruction), sacred/Christian worldview (inferred through language). - Negative keywords: None clearly present in the public AMCA materials (no strong signals of secularism, relativism, or non-religious secular ethics).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keyword indicators present (explicit or clearly implied): 5–6 - Negative keyword indicators present: 0 - Ratio (positive:negative): roughly 5–6:0 - Proportion of explicit positive signals: high among the religious/metaphysical signals observed.

Why this rating - The materials demonstrate a clear Christian/higher-truth orientation and a contextualized theology within education, which aligns with the Positive keyword indicators for Grounded Theology, Liturgical/Communal Practice, and Transcendental Realism as described in the classical rubric. The explicit christ-centered framing and Biblical study presence push Element 1 toward CLASSICAL in spirit, with some caveats around explicit liturgical practices (not strongly evidenced). See the classical lexicon for exact positive/negative anchors.

- References to the Six Essential Elements lexicon for Theology and liturgy are used to ground this rating (positive signals: theology, liturgy, sacred tradition; negative signals would be secular relativism, religious neutrality). Positive indicators are present in AMCA's Christian framing.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - AMCA emphasizes a real-life, classical Christian environment and a goal-related framing around formation and virtue rather than mere information transfer, which aligns with classical aims in spirit. The site explicitly cites a classical Christian education approach. - The stated goal in some materials focuses on preparing students for middle/high school and ongoing education, which suggests a balance between formation and progression. There is a stated orientation toward virtue and character within the Christian framework, consistent with the classical purpose of formation. - The presence of Montessori elements alongside A Beka curricula signals a blended approach rather than a singular classical formation emphasis, which points to a partial classical alignment.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, wisdom, classical, identity in education, love of learning (inferred), purpose-driven education in a theological context. - Negative keywords observed: references to college/career readiness are present in some materials, which intersects with non-classical, purely formation-focused wording; the emphasis still tilts toward formation within a religious framework rather than vocational emphasis.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: multiple (formation, virtue, wisdom, classical, love of learning) - Negative keywords: few explicit negative signals in this category; some vocational orientation appears in some materials (e.g., high school readiness) but not a dominant emphasis. - Ratio: approximately 4–6 positive vs 0–2 negative signals in public phrasing.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds formation and virtue in a classical-religious frame, fulfilling many Positive keyword indicators for this category. However, contemporary language around college readiness and multi-curriculum blends with Montessori and A Beka materials suggest this is not a pure classical formation program; thus SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL. See the lexicon for formation, virtue, and telos cues.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - AMCA uses a mixed curriculum: Montessori elements for early years and A Beka curriculum for many subjects, with explicit notes about early literacy, phonics, math drilling, and writing. This is not the canonical liberal-arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) structure expected in a classical curriculum, nor does it foreground Great Books or a Great Conversation approach. - There is no explicit public articulation of the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium) or Great Books program. The materials emphasize Montessori practice and a Christian curriculum rather than a Trivium/Quadrivium framework. - The public materials emphasize “Classical Christian Environment” rather than explicit Great Books or integrated historic canon of Western literature; no direct Great Conversation language is evident.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Great Books, Trivium, Quadrivium, liberal arts, universal canonical texts are not present; instead we see Montessori, A Beka (non-Great-Books-based) and secular/instructional terms. - Negative keywords observed: absence of “great books,” “Socratic dialogue,” “primary sources,” “liberal arts” in the classical sense, “history as Western civilization canon,” etc.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords (classical-canon signals) present: minimal to none - Negative/neutral indicators (curated non-classical curriculum signals) present: many - Ratio favoring non-classical signals: high in the NOT CLASSICAL direction.

Why this rating - The curriculum signals do not reflect the core classical elements (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Conversation; history-as-canon). The Montessori and A Beka blend points to a non-pure-classical curriculum orientation. Therefore Element 3 is NOT CLASSICAL. Classical lexicon anchors for curriculum emphasize the liberal arts canon and Great Books; those are not evidenced in AMCA's public materials.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Montessori methods are explicitly present for early years, with emphasis on hands-on activities, centers, and guided discovery, signaling a contemplative and child-centered pedagogy in line with some classical sensibilities (memory work and singing are noted in Shurley English and memorization practices in the classical lexicon). The site also notes that upper grades use multiple curriculums and prepare students for high school, which suggests non-uniform pedagogy across grades.

- Explicit classical pedagogical elements (Socratic seminars, scholé, rhetorical training) are not clearly evidenced in the public AMCA materials. The absence of explicit Socratic discourse in the upper grades is a notable gap with respect to classical pedagogy, though the presence of singing/memory-based practices (Shurley English; phonics-based memorization) aligns with the traditional pedagogy described in the classical lexicon.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Scholé (restful learning) and singing/memory in some classical pedagogical language (memory work), Socratic dialogue (not clearly evidenced), recitation, disciplined conversation (not clearly evidenced as classroom practice). - Negative keywords observed: Lack of explicit Socratic seminars, lack of formal “great conversation” or high-school-level rhetoric/seminars in public materials.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords: limited but present via Montessori-based contemplative/restful approaches and early memorization practices. - Negative keywords: explicit Socratic dialogue and formal high-school rhetoric are not evidenced. - Ratio: mixed signals, leaning toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - Pedagogy signals reflect a hybrid approach: Montessori and traditional memory-based practices align with classical pedagogy in parts (recitation/memory). However, the lack of explicit Socratic seminars or scholé language in the public materials places Element 4 in the middle—SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. See the pedagogy lexicon (Socratic dialogue, scholé, memory work) for anchors.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe teachers as facilitators within Montessori classrooms and as part of a “Christian education” framework. Small class sizes are highlighted in AMCA materials, signaling close mentorship and teacher attention, which align with the classical expectation of a teacher as a mentor and living curriculum to some extent. - There is not a clearly articulated “portrait of a teacher” or a robust “living curriculum” statement in the public materials; the faculty description focuses on roles within Montessori classrooms and Christian instruction rather than a canonical classical faculty portrayal.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: teacher as mentor (implied by small-class, intimate classroom settings), “Christ-centered” instruction (teacher role in faith integration), living curriculum (not explicitly stated but implied through classroom practice). - Negative keywords observed: lack of explicit “portrait of a teacher” or “faculty as living curriculum” language in the public materials.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: moderate (mentor/teacher as guide, small class sizes). - Negative keywords present: few explicit classical-faculty identifiers. - Ratio: leaning toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The faculty signaling is present but not deeply elaborated in classical terms. The mix of Montessori and Christian instruction aligns with some classical expectations but lacks the explicit classical-faculty articulation (living curriculum portrait, classical mentor profile). See the living-curriculum/teacher-portrait expectations in the Classical Elements lexicon for grounding.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - AMCA emphasizes Partnership with Families and Parent involvement as core elements, including language about parents as co-teachers, family involvement, and home-school partnership. This aligns strongly with classical-community expectations around parent formation and shared mission. - The school signals openness to parent participation and involvement, including community-facing offerings like parent book studies, gatherings, and information sharing via the website; this aligns with “living tradition in the family” and parental formation found in classical frameworks. - The public materials highlight that AMCA provides opportunities for parent involvement and family engagement, reinforcing the “parents as co-teachers” principle.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental engagement, home-school connection, family involvement, parent formation, community of learners, open campus/visits. - Negative keywords observed: few explicit negative signals; not present are consumer-customer language or minimal parent involvement.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: numerous (partnership with families; parent formation; home-school connection; parental engagement) - Negative keywords: none clearly observed - Ratio: strong positive signal; CLASSICAL in this category

Why this rating - The AMCA materials strongly align with the classical-community ideal of parents as co-educators and active participants in education. The explicit partnership language and family-involvement signals place Element 6 squarely in the CLASSICAL category. The Six Elements lexicon frames this as the “Partnership with Families” and “Formation through the home” signals.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 3 (Curriculum): Publicly articulate and implement a canonical classical curriculum framework (Seven Liberal Arts; Trivium/Quadrivium) and integrate Great Books or primary sources into the curriculum. Offer explicit references to “Great Books” and “Great Conversation” in course descriptions, units, and assessment rubrics.
 - Element 4 (Pedagogy): Increase explicit incorporation of Socratic dialogue/seminar styles in upper grades; frame some courses around scholé/restful learning language and practice; include structured memory work and recitation that aligns with classical pedagogy.
 - Element 5 (Faculty): Publish a clear “portrait of the teacher” and a concise description of how faculty embody the living-curriculum concept, including ongoing professional development in classical-pedagogical methods and teacher formation.
 - Element 2 (Purpose and Goal): Clarify and foreground formation as the primary telos, with explicit statements about virtue formation and contemplation in line with classical paideia, while acknowledging college/school progression. Reduce ambiguity around career-prep emphasis to emphasize formation-first language.
 - Element 1 and Element 6: Maintain strong religious-formation signaling and robust parent-partnerships; consider expanding liturgical/cultural practices language to align with more explicit liturgical-community signals, if desired.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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